



300 CE

301 CE Diocletian issues
the Edict on Maximum
Prices, an attempt to
control inflation

303 CE Diocletian orders
Christian persecution,
killing many who refuse to
renounce their faith

**c. 300 CE Start of
the Classic
Maya period**
in Mesoamerica

NORTHERN CHINA BREAKS INTO 16 KINGDOMS

The Western Jin dynasty became increasingly reliant on non-Chinese northern nomad soldiers such as the Southern Xiongnu. In 304 CE, Liu Yuan, a commander with Xiongnu origins, overthrew the final Jin emperor and declared his own Han Zhao Dynasty. Northern China dissolved into a chaotic mosaic of small states, known as the Sixteen Kingdoms, ruled by other nomadic groups such as the Xianbei and Jie, until its reunification by the Northern Wei in 439 CE.

304 CE

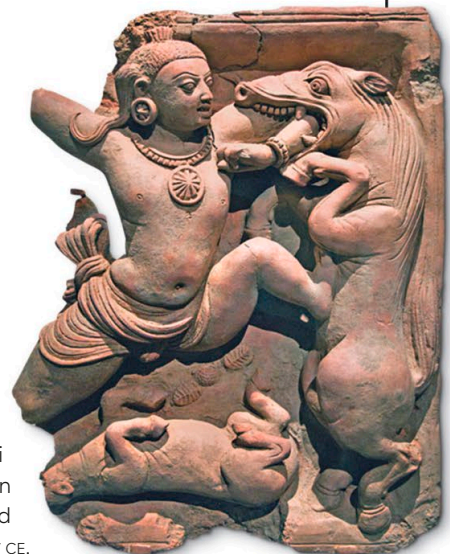


◁ Stoneware from
China's Sixteen
Kingdoms Period

CHANDRAGUPTA ESTABLISHES THE GUPTA EMPIRE

The grandson of Gupta, founder of a small state in Magadha in north-eastern India, Chandragupta established his dynasty's power by marrying a princess of the neighbouring Licchavi state. He expanded his domains into Ayodhya and southern Bihar, beginning the growth of the Gupta empire that would dominate northern India until the 5th century CE.

320 CE



△ Gupta dynasty sculpture of Krishna killing the demon Keshi